

Trividha Upastambha

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- ❑ Trividha Upastambha , or Traya Upastambha , is an Ayurvedic concept that refers to the three pillars of health.
- ❑ The word literally means three pillars or triad of life.
- ❑ The three important pillars can better way be compared with health behaviour of modern day and in fact are the important behavioural determinants of health.
- ❑ In ayurveda, 'Trividha Upastambha' are described in Sutrasthan of Charak Samhita.
- ❑ An optimal state of health, or 'Svastha', according to Ayurveda , can only be achieved when there is a proper balance of the 'Three Pillars of Life'

The three pillars of health are :

- **Aahara** : Diet and nutrition
- **Nidra** : Sleep
- **Brahmacharya** : Celibacy, continence or abstinence . Sexual activities and energies.

These are an essential and integral part of our lives, and when they find harmony, the body , mind and heart follow in living to their full potentiality.

RIGHT DIET

- ✓ Proper diet , digestion and elimination is paramount to our well – being. Through proper digestion , our bodies are able to absorb from the food all the nutrients and the vital life – force energy (Prana) that acts as the building blocks of our bodies and minds.
- ✓ Proper digestion requires the intake of the ideal foods for a person's constitution. It also requires that food be consumed properly, with mindfulness , at proper timings and in proper combination .
- ✓ When the choice of food is not appropriate for the constitution of the person or the food is taken improperly, the result is disturbance of one or more of the body's three doshas .
- ✓ Improper digestion eventually results in disease. Easeful, balanced digestion of all doshic types should bring lightness, joy and peace of body and mind.

RIGHT SLEEP

- ✓ Proper rest is essential for the well – being of any person. The body utilizes sleep as an opportunity to use its energy for healing and repairing damage to the body that accumulated during the waking hours.
- ✓ If the body does not receive enough sleep , the body cannot repair the damage caused by stress and strain. This leads to the body breaking down.
- ✓ Too much or too little sleep brings on consequences.
- ✓ Too much sleeps upsets Vata dosha , while too much sleeps disturbs Kapha dosha.
- ✓ Disturbance of Vata dosha results in weaker tissues that are more susceptible to injury
- ✓ Disturbance of Kapha dosha results in tissues that become excessive , stagnant lethargic and immobile
- ✓ In general, it is best to align our sleeping patterns with the cycles of day and night , and retire by 10 pm and rise with the sun.

BRAHMACHARYA

- ✓ This refers to practicing moderation and self – control in various aspects of life, including managing stress, maintaining balanced relationships, and engaging in activities that promote well – being. It encourages conserving energy and directing it toward positive pursuits.
- ✓ Sexual energy called Shukra , is needed to build Ojas , the energy that provides stability to the body and mind and underlies the strength of the immune system.

Together , these three pillars are considered crucial for sustaining a healthy and balanced life in Ayurvedic philosophy.

Shadrasa

Rasa : when anything comes in contact with the tongue , the experience we experience from it is called Rasa in Ayurveda. If we understand this in common language , the after eating anything , we feel the taste that is the Rasa.

Types of Rasas :

There are six types of Rasas mentioned in Ayurveda .

They are :

- 1) Madhura (sweet)
- 2) Amla (sour)
- 3) Lavana (salty)
- 4) Katu (pungent)
- 5) Tikta (bitter)
- 6) Kashaya (astringent)

1. **Madhura Rasa (sweet)** : the juice which is consumed by satisfaction, happiness and stickiness in the mouth is felt. Along with this, the juice which provides nutrition and increases Kapha is called sweet or Madhura Rasa. Madhura Rasa is congenial to the body, improves body fluid, blood, muscles, nourishes male and female reproductive system.

✓ Disadvantage of excessive consumption of Madhura Rasa :

Obesity, lethargy. Excessive sleepiness, heaviness in the body. Lack of digestive power, diabetes etc.

✓ Madhura Rasa foods : Ghee, Jaggery, Coconut, Banana, Doodh, Liquorice

2. **Amla Rasa (sour)** : consuming the juice causes discharge from the mouth. On eating which the eye and eyebrows shrink and sourness is felt in the teeth, it is acid juice or Amla Rasa. Amla Rasa makes the substances tasty and increases appetite. It feels cold to touch, its consumption increases the strength of the body. The brain becomes more active by the consumption of things containing Amla Rasa,

✓ Disadvantages of excessive consumption of Amla Rasa :

Excess thirst, Sour teeth, melting in phlegm, flaking and pus in the wounds caused by cuts etc.

✓ Amla Rasa foods : Lemon, buttermilk, mango, pomegranate

3. **Lavana Rasa (salt)** : the juice which, when consumed, causes saliva to drip from the mouth and causes sensation in the throat and cheeks, that is called Salt Juice or Lavana Rasa.

✓ Disadvantages of excessive consumption of Lavana Rasa

Imbalance of blood, excessive thirst and heart burning, deterioration of the skin, swelling of the skin, movement of teeth etc.

✓ Lavana Rasa foods : Rock salt, Samudra and Audbhida salt, etc.

Katu Rasa (Pungent) : on consuming this Rasa , a needle like pain is felt in the mouth and stimulates the front part of the tongue. Katu Rasa cleanses the mouth, improves digestion , digestion strength. The substances containing Katu Rasta keep the mouth clean and help in the absorption of food in the body.

Disadvantages of excessive consumption of Katu Rasa :

Fainting, palpitation, dryness of lips, tingling, weakness, loss of strength and semen.

Katu Rasa foods : Ginger, Black pepper etc.

Tikta Rasa (Bitter) : this juice improves the licorice from the mouth and makes the tongue root. Though not so good in taste , when taken, it improves taste in the person, detoxifies , kills germs and worms , burning sensation , etc .

Disadvantages of excessive consumption of Tikta Rasa :

Loss of strength, weakness, fainting, dizziness

Tikta Rasa foods : citrus peel, cranberries, bitter gourd.

Kashaya Rasa (Astringent Juice)

This juice makes the tongue root (numbing) and blocks the throat and the sources.

The Kashaya substances makes the skin clean. They absorb moisture from the body.

Disadvantage of excessive consumption of Kashaya Rasa :

Dryness in the mouth, excessive thirst etc.

Kashaya Rasa foods : Bahera, Broccoli, Lotus seed